

# INTAKE-ARBITER -- FREE-COOLING DECISION REPORT

An agent that decides, hour by hour, whether outside air can cool a data centre.

## THE SITE

Location 165 Halsey / Equinix NY1 / Databank EWR1, NJ -- station KEWR, America/New\_York  
Building OSM 387208881  
165 Halsey / Equinix NY1 / Databank EWR1  
Facade gap not applicable -- one building, no second facade  
Weather record 43,787 real hourly records from KEWR  
Plume physics NOT MODELLED. No other tagged data centre lies inside the solver's validated range, so there is no neighbour intake for a plume to arrive at: the quantity does not exist here rather than being unmeasured. This is a statement about the model's domain, not a claim that recirculation here is zero. A building's own exhaust re-entering its own intake is not modelled at any site in this project.

FortyGuard data: weather and geometry are this site's own; the four measured FortyGuard level offsets and the N-26 coverage record are Ashburn's, because only Ashburn has forecast/outcome day pairs. Quote the hours for this site; quote the coverage for Ashburn.

## THIS REPORT IS A SNAPSHOT, NOT THE LIVE PAGE

The interface recomputes the decision for whatever configuration a reader selects. This file was generated at build time for the ONE configuration named below, chosen because it is the configuration in which this site's agent does the most while still changing mode at least once. If the numbers on screen differ from the numbers here, the configuration differs -- compare the two lists before concluding anything else.

Day 2025-03-29 (crossing)  
Plant limit 18.0 C  
Notice required 3 h  
Forecast skill 0.50 relative to persistence  
Level anchor sensor  
Condenser bank longest facade  
Switch budget 1 mode changes per day  
Minimum dwell 3 h  
Max dew point 15.0 C (Green Grid WP#46 p.6)

## WHAT THE AGENT DID ON THIS DAY

The agent ran free cooling for 3 of 24 hours with 1 mode change. The reactive incumbent took 9 hours -- 6 more -- but declared 0 unsafe hours against the agent's 0. The incumbent had to break its own switch budget 1 time to stay safe; the agent never did. 9 hours were safe but still ran chillers, because the schedule could not afford them.

Agent 3 of 24 hours free cooling, 1 mode change(s), 0 unsafe hour(s)  
Incumbent 9 of 24 hours free cooling, 2 mode change(s), 0 unsafe hour(s)  
the incumbent broke its own switch budget 1 time(s) to stay safe  
9 hour(s) passed every gate and still ran chillers, because the schedule could not afford them

## EVERY HOUR, AND THE REASON FOR IT

| hh | mode       | safe | binding       | bound  | limit | actual | margin |
|----|------------|------|---------------|--------|-------|--------|--------|
| 00 | mechanical | yes  | switch budget | 13.330 | 18.0  | 13.330 | 0.726  |
| 01 | mechanical | yes  | switch budget | 13.055 | 18.0  | 12.780 | 0.674  |
| 02 | mechanical | yes  | switch budget | 13.055 | 18.0  | 12.780 | 0.630  |
| 03 | mechanical | yes  | switch budget | 13.050 | 18.0  | 12.220 | 0.830  |
| 04 | mechanical | yes  | switch budget | 12.500 | 18.0  | 11.670 | 0.741  |

|    |            |     |               |        |      |        |       |
|----|------------|-----|---------------|--------|------|--------|-------|
| 05 | mechanical | yes | switch budget | 12.780 | 18.0 | 12.220 | 0.640 |
| 06 | mechanical | yes | switch budget | 13.055 | 18.0 | 12.780 | 0.671 |
| 07 | mechanical | yes | switch budget | 14.170 | 18.0 | 13.890 | 0.973 |
| 08 | mechanical | yes | switch budget | 16.390 | 18.0 | 15.560 | 1.389 |
| 09 | mechanical | no  | dry-bulb      | 18.890 | 18.0 | 18.890 | 1.425 |
| 10 | mechanical | no  | dry-bulb      | 21.390 | 18.0 | 22.780 | 1.273 |
| 11 | mechanical | no  | dry-bulb      | 23.615 | 18.0 | 26.110 | 1.146 |
| 12 | mechanical | no  | dry-bulb      | 26.110 | 18.0 | 28.330 | 1.141 |
| 13 | mechanical | no  | dry-bulb      | 27.780 | 18.0 | 28.890 | 0.933 |
| 14 | mechanical | no  | dry-bulb      | 28.330 | 18.0 | 27.220 | 1.022 |
| 15 | mechanical | no  | dry-bulb      | 29.170 | 18.0 | 27.780 | 0.893 |
| 16 | mechanical | no  | dry-bulb      | 29.165 | 18.0 | 27.780 | 1.039 |
| 17 | mechanical | no  | dry-bulb      | 27.780 | 18.0 | 27.780 | 0.874 |
| 18 | mechanical | no  | dry-bulb      | 20.555 | 18.0 | 13.330 | 0.869 |
| 19 | mechanical | no  | dry-bulb      | 19.725 | 18.0 | 11.670 | 1.011 |
| 20 | mechanical | no  | dry-bulb      | 18.890 | 18.0 | 10.000 | 1.034 |
| 21 | FREE       | yes | -             | 11.665 | 18.0 | 10.000 | 0.942 |
| 22 | FREE       | yes | -             | 10.000 | 18.0 | 8.330  | 0.850 |
| 23 | FREE       | yes | -             | 8.890  | 18.0 | 7.780  | 0.773 |

bound = the agent's 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air, forecast plus margin

actual = what the intake temperature turned out to be, from the station record

margin = group-conditional forecast error for that hour of day, plus plume spread

## THE REASONING, HOUR BY HOUR

### 00:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 13.330 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

### 01:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 13.055 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

### 02:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 13.055 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

### 03:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 13.050 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

### 04:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 12.500 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a

thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

**05:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]**

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 12.780 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

**06:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]**

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 13.055 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

**07:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]**

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 14.170 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

**08:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]**

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 16.390 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 1 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

**09:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]**

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 18.890 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 0.890 C. It would take a limit 0.890 C higher, or a bound 0.890 C tighter, to change this hour.

**10:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]**

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 21.390 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 3.390 C. It would take a limit 3.390 C higher, or a bound 3.390 C tighter, to change this hour.

**11:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]**

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 23.615 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 5.615 C. It would take a limit 5.615 C higher, or a bound 5.615 C tighter, to change this hour.

**12:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]**

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 26.110 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 8.110 C. It would take a limit 8.110 C higher, or a bound 8.110 C tighter, to change this hour.

**13:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]**

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 27.780 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 9.780 C. It would take a limit 9.780 C higher, or a bound 9.780 C tighter, to change this hour.

**14:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]**

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 28.330 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 10.330 C. It would take a limit 10.330 C higher, or a bound 10.330 C tighter, to change this hour.

**15:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]**

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 29.170 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 11.170 C. It would take a limit 11.170 C higher, or a bound 11.170 C tighter, to change this hour.

**16:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]**

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 29.165 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 11.165 C. It would take a limit 11.165 C higher, or a bound 11.165 C tighter, to change this hour.

**17:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]**

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 27.780 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 9.780 C. It would take a limit 9.780 C higher, or a bound 9.780 C tighter, to change this hour.

**18:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]**

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 20.555 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 2.555 C. It would take a limit 2.555 C higher, or a bound 2.555 C tighter, to change this hour.

**19:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]**

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 19.725 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 1.725 C. It would take a limit 1.725 C higher, or a bound 1.725 C tighter, to change this hour.

**20:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]**

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 18.890 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 0.890 C. It would take a limit 0.890 C higher, or a bound 0.890 C tighter, to change this hour.

**21:00 FREE-COOLING**

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 11.665 C, which is 6.335 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 0.942 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 0.942 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

**22:00 FREE-COOLING**

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 10.000 C, which is 8.000 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 0.850 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 0.850 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

**23:00 FREE-COOLING**

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 8.890 C, which is 9.110 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 0.773 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 0.773 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

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